STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE FOR ELEVATED ROOFING WORK.

1. Planning and preparation

1.1 Pre-job safety meeting

- The supervisor must conduct a pre-start or "toolbox talk" with all crew members.
- Topics should include project scope, site-specific hazards (e.g., power lines, fragile surfaces, weather), safe work procedures, and a fall rescue plan.
- All attendees must sign a register confirming they understand the safety talk.

1.2 Site and structural assessment

- A competent person must inspect the structure to ensure it is suitable for the planned roofing work.
- Confirm that all framing, such as main rafters and purlins, is complete and correctly aligned per the engineered drawings.
- Visually inspect the existing structure for any signs of deterioration or damage.

1.3 Weather conditions

- Check the weather forecast before and during work. Do not work in conditions of high wind, rain, snow, or lightning, as these create slip and fall hazards.
- Ensure all loose sheets and materials are securely tied down if work is interrupted by weather.

1.4 Material preparation

- Pre-cut and pre-assemble as much of the structural material as possible on the ground to minimize work at height.
- For metal structures, apply any required coatings or paint before lifting the material.
- Organize and stage materials in a way that provides workers with safe and quick access.

2. Safety and access procedures

2.1 Personal protective equipment (PPE)

All personnel working on or near the roof must wear the following PPE:

- Hard hat with chin strap
- Safety glasses or goggles
- Full-body harness with a fall arrest system
- Safety footwear with good traction
- Gloves
- Hearing protection in noisy areas

2.2 Fall protection systems

- For any work at height, a fall prevention system is the first priority. This can include scaffolds with guardrails, elevated work platforms, or edge protection.
- Install safety nets beneath the work area as a collective fall-arrest measure.
- Implement a personal fall arrest system (PFAS) for each worker. This includes a full-body harness connected to a lifeline with a rope grab.
- Anchor points for lifelines must be rated to withstand the required load and be certified annually.

2.3 Access and egress

- Use secured ladders or scaffold access towers for getting on and off the roof.
- Maintain three points of contact when using a ladder.
- Do not use ladders for extended work; they are for access only.

3.1 Lifting and handling materials

- Use hoists, cranes, or gin poles for lifting heavy or long structural components. Use web slings and tag lines to control the load and prevent swinging.
- Ensure no personnel are in the lifting radius or under a suspended load.
- Distribute structural components (e.g., purlins) evenly across the rafters and securely tie them down before installation.

3.2 Installation of structural components

- Fasten all purlins and framing according to engineered specifications using self-tapping screws or other specified fasteners.
- Verify that bracing is installed as specified to ensure the structural system's lateral stability before proceeding.
- Place decking or sheathing sequentially, securing each panel to prevent it from being moved by the wind.
- Ensure that walkways and anchor slings are available on the new sheathing as work progresses to provide fall protection.

3.3 Electrical safety

- Identify and clearly mark all electrical hazards, such as power lines, on the job site plan.
- Maintain the required minimum approach distance (MAD) from all power lines.
- If work must be done near power lines, contact the power company to de-energize the lines or confirm safety protocols.

3.4 Housekeeping

- Keep the work area clean and clear of all debris, scrap materials, and tools that could create tripping hazards or fall on people below.
- Isolate the area below any active work to prevent falling materials from striking workers or the public.
- At the end of each day, perform a thorough cleanup and remove or secure all loose items.